

Last time we introduced the question of what we should believe. We began by considering this rule of belief:

No Proof $\rightarrow$ No Belief

If you can't give a good
argument for P, don't
believe P.

But we saw that this led to the result that you should not believe anything at all, which seems very implausible.

At the very least, it seems, we should believe things that we can be certain of:

This is a version of a view known as foundationalism.

It can be summed up with the following negative rule of belief:

No Foundations → No Belief

If you can't be certain that P and your senses don't tell you that P and you can't give a good argument for P, you should not believe P.

Foundationalism is the view that the only basic beliefs you should have are the ones you can be certain of and ones which your senses tell you are true.

Certainty $\rightarrow$ Belief

If you can rule out any situation which would make P false, you should believe P.

Experience → Belief

If your sense experience tells you that P, and you have no reason to think that your sense experience is misleading, you should believe P.

Good Argument → Belief

If there is a valid
argument for P and you
should believe each of
that argument's
premises, you should
believe P.

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This is an appealing idea. The core thought is that only two routes to

figuring out what the world is like and our ability to see that